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IMAGE PICKUP APPARATUS WITH ACCESSORY SHOE

Abstract

Provided is an image pickup apparatus to which an accessory is allowed to be attached while a handle is attached to an accessory shoe of an image pickup apparatus main body, without enlarging the image pickup apparatus main body. An image pickup apparatus includes a main body, a handle detachably attachable to the main body, a first accessory shoe on a top surface of the main body, and a second accessory shoe on a top surface of the handle. The second accessory shoe is attachable with an accessory that is attachable on the first accessory shoe. An electrical contact to be electrically connected to the first accessory shoe is located on a bottom surface of the handle. An electrical connection is located inside the handle to electrically connect the electrical contact and the second accessory shoe.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

[0001] The present invention relates to image pickup apparatuses equipped with an accessory shoe.

Description of the Related Art

[0002] Some image pickup apparatuses, such as video cameras, are equipped with a handle part to be used for shooting and carrying. In addition, some image pickup apparatuses are configured such that a handle part is attachable to and detachable from a main body of the image pickup apparatus in consideration of storage, handling, and the like.

[0003] For example, a known image pickup apparatus has a structure such that a main body of the image pickup apparatus includes an accessory shoe, and a handle part includes a slide sheet metal to be engaged with the accessory shoe of the main body (see, for example, Japanese Laid-Open Patent Publication (kokai) No. 2021-32952). The slide sheet metal and the accessory shoe are engaged and screwed together, so that the handle part is firmly fixed to the main body of the image pickup apparatus.

[0004] Some accessory shoes of image pickup apparatus main bodies have an electrical contact. Instead of a handle part, an accessory, such as an audio microphone, can be attached to the image pickup apparatus main body so as to extend functions of an image pickup apparatus by electrically communicating with the image pickup apparatus main body via the electrical contact. When a handle part is attached to such an accessory shoe of an image pickup apparatus main body to which any of various accessories can be attached as described above, no other accessories can be attached to the image pickup apparatus main body. When a plurality of accessory shoes is provided in an image pickup apparatus main body so that other accessories can be attached to the image pickup apparatus main body with a handle part being attached thereto, it increases a size of the image pickup apparatus main body.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0005] The present invention provides image pickup apparatuses to which an accessory is allowed to be attached while a handle is attached to an accessory shoe of an image pickup apparatus main body, without enlarging the image pickup apparatus main body.

[0006] According to an aspect of the invention, an image pickup apparatus includes a main body, a handle configured to be detachably attachable to the main body, a first accessory shoe on a top surface of the main body, on which an accessory is attachable, and a second accessory shoe on a top surface of the handle, on which an accessory is attachable. The second accessory shoe is attachable with an accessory that is attachable on the first accessory shoe. The image pickup apparatus further includes an electrical contact on a bottom surface of the handle, to be electrically connected to the first accessory shoe, and includes an electrical connection located inside the handle to electrically connect the electrical contact and the second accessory shoe.

[0007] According to the present invention, it is possible to attach an accessory to an image pickup apparatus main body while a handle is attached to an accessory shoe of the image pickup apparatus main body, without enlarging the image pickup apparatus main body.

[0008] Further features of the present invention will become apparent from the following description of exemplary embodiments with reference to the attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0009] FIGS. 1A and 1B are external views of an image pickup apparatus according to the present

embodiment.

[0010] FIGS. 2A and 2B are external views illustrating a handle unit being detached from an image pickup apparatus main body in FIGS. 1A and 1B.

[0011] FIGS. 3A and 3B are internal configuration diagrams of the handle unit in FIGS. 1A and 1B.

[0012] FIG. 4 is an external view illustrating an external microphone being attached to the image pickup apparatus main body in FIGS. 1A and 1B.

[0013] FIG. 5 is an external view illustrating an external microphone being attached to the handle unit fixed to the image pickup apparatus main body in FIGS. 1A and 1B.

[0014] FIG. 6 is an external view of a bottom surface of the handle unit in FIGS. 1A and 1B.

[0015] FIG. 7 is an external view of a side surface of the handle unit in FIGS. 1A and 1B.

[0016] FIGS. 8A and 8B are a perspective views illustrating an internal configuration of the handle unit in FIGS. 1A and 1B.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

[0017] The present invention will now be described in detail below with reference to the accompanying drawings showing embodiments thereof.

[0018] Here, for convenience of description, a coordinate system is defined as illustrated in FIGS. 1A and 1B. The Z axis is defined as a front-rear direction along an optical axis of an image pickup apparatus (a front lens side is defined as a +Z direction), the Y axis is defined as an up-down direction of the image pickup apparatus (a top surface side is defined as a +Y direction), and the X axis is defined as a left-right direction of the image pickup apparatus (a right surface side as viewed from the front is defined as a +X direction). An image pickup apparatus according to the present embodiment is a lens-interchangeable image pickup apparatus, and will be hereinafter referred to simply as an image pickup apparatus.

[0019] First, an outline of an image pickup apparatus **100** according to the present embodiment is be described with reference to FIGS. 1A and 1B.

[0020] FIGS. 1A and 1B are external views of the image pickup apparatus **100**. FIG. 1A is a perspective view of the image pickup apparatus **100** when viewed from the front thereof, and FIG. 1B is a perspective view of the image pickup apparatus **100** when viewed from the back thereof.

[0021] As illustrated in FIGS. 1A and 1B, the image pickup apparatus **100** includes an image pickup apparatus main body **101** and a handle unit **200**. The image pickup apparatus main body **101** has a hexahedron shape, and one surface of the body is provided with a mount part **102** on which an interchangeable lens unit is mountable and with a built-in microphone part **103** for recording sound.

[0022] It should be noted that, a surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** on which the mount part **102** and the built-in microphone part **103** are provided is defined as a front surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, and a surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** opposite to the front surface is defined as a rear surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. Furthermore, a side surface on the right of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** as viewed from the front is defined as a right surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, and a side surface on the left of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** as viewed from the front is defined as a left surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. Furthermore, a surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** to which the handle unit **200** is attachable is defined as a top surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, and a surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** opposite to the top surface is defined as a bottom surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**.

[0023] The right surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** is provided with an operation button group **104** that receives an operation of an operator and then causes the image pickup apparatus main body **101** to execute a predetermined operation, and with a recording medium storage lid **105** that covers a storage chamber that stores a recording medium (which is not illustrated).

[0024] The rear surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** is provided with a battery housing **107** that houses a battery **106** that supplies power to the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, and with an input/output terminal group **108** including an external connection terminal and a power terminal.

[0025] The left surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** is provided with an intake port **109** for drawing low-temperature air into the image pickup apparatus main body **101** by using an internal fan (which is not illustrated) and with an exhaust port **110** for discharging high-temperature air to the outside. In addition, a grip **300** is detachably provided on the left surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, which allows an operator to perform various operations while gripping the grip **300**.

[0026] A handle unit **200** for an operator to hold is detachably provided on the top surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. It should be noted that a method for fixing the handle unit **200** to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** will be described later.

[0027] A rod fixing part **401** is detachably provided in front of the handle unit **200**, and a rod **402** having a circular cross section is inserted through the rod fixing part **401**. A slide rail **403** is provided on an end of the rod **402** opposite to the rod fixing part **401**, and the rod **402** is inserted through the slide rail **403** in the same manner. A slide base **404** is provided on the slide rail **403** to be slidable. The slide base **404** is provided with a triaxial rotation mechanism **405** capable of rotating in an axial direction parallel to each of the X axis, the Y axis, and the Z axis.

[0028] A display panel unit **410** configured to display an image is detachably attached to the other end of the triaxial rotation mechanism **405**. The display panel unit **410** is electrically connected to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** via a detachable connection cable **411**, and thus video signals and the like are transmitted and received between the display panel unit **410** and the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. With such a configuration, the display panel unit **410** can move to a position within its movable range with a high degree of freedom.

[0029] A cable holding part **201** (see FIG. 2B) configured to hold a cable such as the connection cable **411** is provided in the front of the handle unit **200** so that the cable holding part **201** is detachable from the handle unit **200**.

[0030] Next, how to attach and fix the handle unit **200** to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** is described with reference to FIGS. 2A and 2B.

[0031] FIGS. 2A and 2B are external views illustrating the handle unit **200** being detached from the image pickup apparatus main body **101** in FIGS. 1A and 1B. FIG. 2A is a perspective view of the handle unit **200** being detached from the image pickup apparatus main body **101** as viewed from the left of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. FIG. 2B is a perspective view of the handle unit **200** being detached from the image pickup apparatus main body **101** as viewed from the right of the image pickup apparatus **100**.

[0032] As illustrated in FIG. 2A, the top surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** is provided with a first fixing part **121**, a second fixing part **122**, and a third fixing part **123** to which the handle unit **200** is fixed. On the other hand, as illustrated in FIG. 2B, the bottom surface of the handle unit **200** is provided with a first screw part **221** to be fastened to the first fixing part **121**, a second screw part **222** to be fastened to the second fixing part **122**, and a third screw part **223** to be fastened to the third fixing part **123**. The first screw part **221**, the second screw part **222**, and the third screw part **223** serve as fixing parts of the handle unit **200**.

[0033] As illustrated in FIG. 2A, a main body accessory shoe **124** on which an accessory is attachable is provided on the top surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. The main body accessory shoe **124** has an electrical contact. On the main body accessory shoe **124**, an accessory, such as an external microphone, is attachable, where the accessory extends functions of the image pickup apparatus **100** by electrically communicating with the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. On the other hand, as illustrated in FIG. 2B, a handle contact part **224** to be attached to the main body accessory shoe **124** is provided on the bottom surface of the handle unit

200.

[0034] When the handle unit **200** is attached to the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, the handle unit **200** is slid forward from the rear on the top surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, and the first screw part **221**, the second screw part **222**, and the third screw part **223** are screwed into the first fixing part **121**, the second fixing part **122**, and the third fixing part **123**, respectively, so that the handle unit **200** is fixed to the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. In this case, the main body accessory shoe **124** of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** and the handle contact part **224** of the handle unit **200** are electrically connected via an electrical connection structure provided inside the handle unit **200**.

[0035] Here, in the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, the first fixing part **121** and the main body accessory shoe **124** are located substantially on the optical axis of the image pickup apparatus **100** when viewed from above the image pickup apparatus **100**. The first fixing part **121** is located in the front (on the side close to the front surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**) of the top surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, and the main body accessory shoe **124** is located in the rear (on the side close to the rear surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**) of the top surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. In contrast, in the handle unit **200**, the first screw part **221** and the handle contact part **224** are located substantially on the optical axis when the image pickup apparatus **100** is viewed from below. The first screw part **221** is located in the front (on the side close to the front surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**) of the bottom surface of the handle unit **200**, and the handle contact part **224** is located in the rear (on the side close to the rear surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**) of the bottom surface of the handle unit **200**.

[0036] A handle accessory shoe **225** is provided on the top surface of the handle unit **200**. The handle accessory shoe **225** has the same shape as the main body accessory shoe **124**, and has an electrical contact similarly to the main body accessory shoe **124**. Thus, the handle accessory shoe **225** is attachable with an accessory such as the above-described external microphone that is attachable on the main body accessory shoe **124** of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**.

[0037] Next, an electrical connection structure inside the handle unit **200** is described. FIGS. **3A** and **3B** are internal configuration diagrams of the handle unit **200** in FIGS. **1A** and **1B**. It should be noted that FIGS. **3A** and **3B** illustrate the handle unit **200** with the exterior cover removed. FIG. **3A** is a perspective view of the handle unit **200** as viewed from the bottom surface side thereof. FIG. **3B** is a perspective view of the handle unit **200** as viewed from the top surface side thereof.

[0038] In the handle unit **200**, the handle contact part **224** is electrically connected to a first circuit board **227** via a first electrical connection component **226**, as illustrated in FIG. **3A**. In the present embodiment, the first electrical connection component **226** is, for example, a flexible printed circuit board, and is routed in a space inside the handle unit **200**, which is narrow in a thickness direction of the first electrical connection component **226**.

[0039] In the handle unit **200**, the first circuit board **227** is electrically connected to a second circuit board **229** via a second electrical connection component **228**, as illustrated in FIG. **3B**. The second electrical connection component **228** is, for example, an internal wiring wire, and is routed from the lower portion to the upper portion of the handle unit **200** through a gap of a handle frame **230** inside the handle unit **200**. The second circuit board **229** is electrically connected to the handle accessory shoe **225** via a third electrical connection component **231**. The third electrical connection component **231** is, for example, a flexible printed circuit board, and is routed in a narrow space. With the above configuration, the handle contact part **224** of the handle unit **200** and the handle accessory shoe **225** are electrically communicatively connected via a circuit board and/or an electrical connection component inside the handle unit **200**.

[0040] Further, the first circuit board **227** is arranged near the handle contact part **224**, and the second circuit board **229** is arranged near the handle accessory shoe **225**. As will be described later, the handle unit **200** is configured to transmit signals for communicating electrically with the main

body accessory shoe **124**. For this reason, a correction circuit including a buffer that corrects signals for electrical communication is provided on each of the first circuit board **227** arranged near the handle contact part **224** connected to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** and the second circuit board **229** arranged near the handle accessory shoe **225** connected to an accessory.

[0041] FIG. **4** is an external view illustrating an external microphone **350** being attached to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** in FIGS. **1A** and **1B**. For example, as illustrated in FIG. **4**, the external microphone **350**, which is an external accessory, is attached on the main body accessory shoe **124** in the rear of the top surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. The external microphone **350** becomes usable by being electrically connected to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** through connection of an electric wiring component (which is not illustrated). The external microphone **350** has functions such as switching of directivity and digital signal processing, and is configured to record sound with higher quality than that of the built-in microphone part **103** included in the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. That is, the audio functions of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** are extended by attaching the external microphone **350** to the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. Furthermore, as described above, by arranging the main body accessory shoe **124** in the rear of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, the external microphone **350** can be easily attached from the rear of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**.

[0042] FIG. **5** is an external view illustrating the external microphone **350** being attached to the handle unit **200** fixed to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** in FIGS. **1A** and **1B**. As described with reference to FIGS. **2A**, **2B**, **3A**, and **3B**, when the handle unit **200** is attached to the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, the main body accessory shoe **124** of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** and the handle contact part **224** of the handle unit **200** are electrically connected. In this state, the handle unit **200** is fixed to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** by tightening each of the first screw part **221**, the second screw part **222**, and the third screw part **223**.

[0043] The external microphone **350**, which is an external accessory, is attached on the handle accessory shoe **225** in the front of the top surface of the handle unit **200**. In this state, the external microphone **350** is connected to the handle contact part **224** via the handle accessory shoe **225** and an electrical connection component inside the handle unit **200**, and is further electrically communicatively connected to the main body accessory shoe **124** of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**.

[0044] As a result, the external microphone **350** becomes usable by electrically communicating with the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. That is, an accessory that is usable by being attached to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** also becomes usable even in a state in which the handle unit **200** is attached to the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. In other words, a signal for electrical communication between the accessory and the image pickup apparatus main body **101** is transmitted via the electrical connection component provided in the handle unit **200**, which allows the accessory to be attached to and used at a position different from the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. Therefore, an accessory can be used along with the image pickup apparatus **100** to suite various use modes of the image pickup apparatus **100** without providing a new accessory shoe on the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. As a result, it is possible to improve the convenience of the image pickup apparatus **100** at the time of shooting without increasing the size of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. For example, when it is desired to attach the external microphone **350** at a position higher than the image pickup apparatus main body **101** or on the subject side, the external microphone **350** can be used by being attached on the handle accessory shoe **225** while the handle unit **200** is attached to the image pickup apparatus main body **101**.

[0045] In addition, as described above, the handle accessory shoe **225** is arranged in the front of the top surface of the handle unit **200**, so that an operator can hold the handle unit **200** without

hindrance even in a state in which an accessory is attached on the handle accessory shoe **225**.

[0046] It should be noted that, in the present embodiment, the configuration has been described in which each of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** and the handle unit **200** includes one accessory shoe, but the configuration is not limited to this. For example, the handle unit **200** may include a plurality of accessory shoes, and the accessory shoes may have the same specification or different specifications. Further, the accessory shoes may be configured to be used simultaneously or may be configured to be used alternately rather than simultaneously.

[0047] Next, a configuration of the bottom surface of the handle unit **200** is described with reference to FIG. **6**. FIG. **6** is an external view of the bottom surface of the handle unit **200** in FIGS. **1A** and **1B**.

[0048] As illustrated in FIG. **6**, the bottom surface of the handle unit **200** is provided with a plurality of ribs (at least two protrusions) extending substantially parallel to the top surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, specifically, a first protrusion **505**, a second protrusion **506**, and a third protrusion **507**. The first protrusion **505** is located near the first screw part **221**. In the present embodiment, the first protrusion **505** extends in the optical axis direction with a constant width, facing the first screw part **221**, and has a protrusion shape protruding in the $-Y$ direction (the direction toward the image pickup apparatus main body **101**) from the bottom surface of the handle unit **200**.

[0049] Similarly to the first protrusion **505**, the second protrusion **506** is located near the first screw part **221**, and faces the first protrusion **505** across the optical axis and the first screw part **221**. The second protrusion **506** has substantially the same shape as the first protrusion **505**. The first protrusion **505** and the second protrusion **506** are substantially parallel.

[0050] The third protrusion **507** is located at the approximate center of the second screw part **222** and the third screw part **223**, and has a protrusion shape protruding in the $-Y$ direction (the direction toward the image pickup apparatus main body **101**) from the bottom surface of the handle unit **200**. The third protrusion **507** is formed to surround three sides of the back of the handle contact part **224** and the left and right of the handle contact part **224**, and has a substantially U-shaped protrusion shape in which a left part **507a**, a rear part **507b**, and a right part **507c** are connected. In addition, the third protrusion **507** protrudes more than the handle contact part **224** when viewed from the side surface side of the handle unit **200**.

[0051] It should be noted that a rib part of the third protrusion **507** is not located in front of the handle contact part **224**. This provides an opening for the handle unit **200** to slide from the rear surface side toward the front surface side of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** and to be connected to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** via the handle contact part **224**.

[0052] As illustrated in FIG. **6**, on the bottom surface of the handle unit **200**, the first screw part **221** is provided in the front of the handle unit **200**, and the second screw part **222** and the third screw part **223** are provided in the rear of the handle unit **200**. The first screw part **221** is located substantially on the optical axis. The second screw part **222** and the third screw part **223** are located at positions facing each other across the optical axis when viewed from the bottom surface side of the handle unit **200**. The handle contact part **224** is disposed substantially on the optical axis. That is, the handle contact part **224** is located at an intermediate position between the second screw part **222** and the third screw part **223**. The handle contact part **224** is located on the bottom surface of the handle unit **200**, at a position overlapping at least a part of a region formed by connecting the first screw part **221**, the second screw part **222**, and the third screw part **223**. With the arrangement, the handle contact part **224** lies within in a region of the bottom surface of the handle unit **200** that is firmly fixed to the image pickup apparatus main body **101** by the three fixing parts, and this improves the connection reliability between the main body accessory shoe **124** of the image pickup apparatus main body **101** and the handle contact part **224** of the handle unit **200**. Next, a relationship between the three protrusions provided in the handle unit **200** and the handle contact part **224** is described with reference to FIG. **7**.

[0053] FIG. 7 is an external view of the side surface of the handle unit **200** in FIGS. **1A** and **1B**. As illustrated in FIG. 7, the third protrusion **507** protrudes more than (further below) the handle contact part **224** when viewed from the side surface side of the handle unit **200**.

[0054] A plane **508** indicates a plane formed by connecting the root portions of the first protrusion **505**, the second protrusion **506**, and the third protrusion **507**. A plane **509** indicates a plane formed by connecting the top portions of the first protrusion **505**, the second protrusion **506**, and the third protrusion **507**, that is, a plane formed by connecting the outermost portions of the bottom surface of the handle unit **200**. As illustrated in FIG. 7, the entire handle contact part **224** is positioned closer to the handle unit **200** than the plane **509**. Therefore, when the handle unit **200** alone is placed on a floor, a desk, or the like or falls on the ground or the like, the three ribs (the first protrusion **505**, the second protrusion **506**, and the third protrusion **507**) hit the ground or the like before the handle contact part **224**. This prevents the handle contact part **224** from being broken. It should be noted that the arrangement of a plurality of protrusions and the handle contact part **224** is not particularly limited. It is sufficient if one of the protrusions is located in the front of the handle unit **200**, another is located in the rear of the handle unit **200** and near the handle contact part **224**, and when the handle unit **200** is viewed from the side surface side of the handle unit **200**, the entire handle contact part **224** is located closer to the handle unit **200** than a line connecting the most protruding point of one protrusion and the most protruding point of another protrusion.

[0055] Next, connection between various circuit boards and the ground (GND) is described with reference to FIGS. **8A** and **8B**.

[0056] FIGS. **8A** and **8B** are perspective views illustrating an internal configuration of the handle unit **200** in FIGS. **1A** and **1B**. It should be noted that FIGS. **8A** and **8B** illustrate the handle unit **200** with the exterior cover removed. FIG. **8A** is a perspective view of the handle unit **200** as viewed from the bottom surface side, and FIG. **8B** is a perspective view of the handle unit **200** as viewed from the top surface side.

[0057] As illustrated in FIG. **8A**, the handle contact part **224** and the first circuit board **227** are arranged on the bottom surface of the handle unit **200**, and as illustrated in FIG. **8B**, the second circuit board **229** is arranged on the top surface of the handle unit **200**. A sheet metal **522** (conductive member) made of a metal material such as stainless steel is disposed on both side surfaces of the handle unit **200**.

[0058] Each of the second circuit board **229** and the first circuit board **227** has a portion where a copper foil is exposed, and these circuit boards are electrically connected to the sheet metal **522** serving as a ground due to contact between each copper foil portion and the sheet metal **522**.

[0059] As illustrated in FIG. **8A**, a handle engagement component **523** to be engaged with the image pickup apparatus main body **101** is arranged around the first screw part **221** on the bottom surface of the handle unit **200**. As illustrated in FIG. **2A**, a main body engagement component **125** to be engaged with the handle unit **200** is arranged around the first fixing part **121** on the top surface of the image pickup apparatus main body **101**. Each of the handle engagement component **523** and the main body engagement component **125** is formed of a metal component. When the handle unit **200** is fixed to the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, the main body engagement component **125** and the handle engagement component **523** are engaged with each other, so that the image pickup apparatus main body **101** and the handle unit **200** can be firmly fixed.

[0060] The second circuit board **229**, the first circuit board **227**, and the handle engagement component **523** are connected to the sheet metal **522** serving as a ground. When the handle unit **200** is fixed to the image pickup apparatus main body **101**, the main body engagement component **125** and the handle engagement component **523** are connected. With such a configuration, a reference potential of signals in a case where the image pickup apparatus main body **101** and the handle unit **200** are electrically communicatively connected is stabilized, and thus radiation noise can be reduced. Further, resistance to external noise can be improved.

[0061] While the present invention has been described with reference to exemplary embodiments,

it is to be understood that the invention is not limited to the disclosed exemplary embodiments. The scope of the following claims is to be accorded the broadest interpretation so as to encompass all such modifications and equivalent structures and functions.

[0062] For example, for an electrical connection structure inside the handle unit **200**, the handle contact part **224** and the handle accessory shoe **225** may be directly connected without interposing a circuit board.

[0063] This application claims the benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2024-033693, filed Mar. 6, 2024, which is hereby incorporated by reference wherein in its entirety.

Claims

1. An image pickup apparatus comprising: a main body; a handle configured to be detachably attachable to the main body; a first accessory shoe on a top surface of the main body, on which an accessory is attachable; a second accessory shoe on a top surface of the handle, on which an accessory is attachable, wherein the second accessory shoe is attachable with an accessory that is attachable on the first accessory shoe; an electrical contact on a bottom surface of the handle, to be electrically connected to the first accessory shoe; and an electrical connection located inside the handle to electrically connect the electrical contact and the second accessory shoe.
2. The image pickup apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the first accessory shoe is located in a rear of a top surface of the main body, and the electrical contact is located in a rear of the bottom surface of the handle.
3. The image pickup apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the second accessory shoe is located in a front of the top surface of the handle.
4. The image pickup apparatus according to claim 1, further comprising a cable holder provided in a front of the handle so as to be detachable from the handle, the cable holder being configured to hold a cable of an accessory.
5. The image pickup apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the handle includes at least two protrusions protruding from the bottom surface of the handle toward the main body and extending substantially parallel to the top surface of the main body, a first protrusion of the at least two protrusions is located in a front of the handle, a second protrusion of the at least two protrusions is located in a rear of the handle and near the electrical contact, and when the handle is viewed from a side surface side of the handle, the entire electrical contact is located closer to the handle than a line connecting a most protruding point of the first protrusion and a most protruding point of the second protrusion.
6. The image pickup apparatus according to claim 1, wherein a first fixing part, a second fixing part, and a third fixing part are arranged on the bottom surface of the handle, the first fixing part is located on an optical axis of the image pickup apparatus in a front of the handle, and the second fixing part and the third fixing part are located at positions facing each other across the optical axis in a rear of the handle, and wherein the electrical contact is located on the bottom surface of the handle, at a position overlapping at least a part of a region formed by connecting the first fixing part, the second fixing part, and the third fixing part.
7. The image pickup apparatus according to claim 6, wherein the handle includes a first protrusion, a second protrusion, and a third protrusion protruding from the bottom surface of the handle toward the main body and extending substantially parallel to the top surface of the main body, the first protrusion and the second protrusion are located at positions facing each other across the first fixing part, and the third protrusion extends to surround a back of the electrical contact and both sides of the electrical contact, and protrudes more than the electrical contact when viewed from a side surface side of the handle.
8. The image pickup apparatus according to claim 1, further comprising: a first board on the bottom surface of the handle; a handle engagement component on the bottom surface of the handle, to be

engaged with the main body; a second board on the top surface of the handle; a conductive member connecting the first board, the second board, and the handle engagement component; and a main body engagement component on the top surface of the main body, to be engaged with the handle, wherein the handle engagement component and the main body engagement component are to be connected.
